INTRODUCTION · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Start here: the KCNA course

What the exam is, how this course works, and the route that gets you ready fastest.

EXAM KCNA RUNS 8 hours 33 minutes MODULES 35 plus this one

admin@sthithapragna.com

KCNA tests whether you can **choose correctly** between options that all sound right. This course trains exactly that.

The exam at a glance

ITEM	DETAIL
Certification	Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate, from the CNCF and the Linux Foundation
Format	Online, remotely proctored, multiple choice
Time and questions	90 minutes; about 60 questions, as widely reported
Pass mark	75%
Price and attempts	US$250, including one retake
Validity	Two years. No prerequisites

REMEMBER

Check the Linux Foundation's exam page the week you book: details can change.

The four domains, and where they are taught

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MODULES	WORKED SCENARIOS
Kubernetes Fundamentals	44%	1 to 12	56
Container Orchestration	28%	13 to 21	44
Cloud Native Application Delivery	16%	22 to 25	28
Cloud Native Architecture	12%	26 to 28	16

ON THE EXAM

Teaching time follows the weights. Nearly three quarters of the exam is the first two domains.

Who this course is for

- **For** anyone new to Kubernetes: developers, operations, testers, managers, students.
- **No Kubernetes experience needed.** Module 1 starts from what a container actually is.
- **Helpful but not required:** basic command-line comfort, and a rough idea of what a server is.
- **Not a hands-on lab course.** For CKA or CKAD you will need a keyboard as well.

> REMEMBER
>
> KCNA is conceptual. You will read commands and manifests, but never type them in the exam.

Read this first: a lot of study material is out of date

- **The curriculum changed on 24 November 2025:** five domains became four, and Delivery doubled.
- **Much older material is now wrong:** PodSecurityPolicy, SMI, OpenTracing, the Ingress NGINX controller.
- **This course teaches what is true today,** and flags every change on a 'Currency check' slide.
- **Module 29** gathers every change in one place, with a strategy for dated questions.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> If you studied from older notes or question banks, watch for the currency-check slides.

How this course was built

- **Mapped to the current curriculum,** topic by topic, with teaching time following the weights.
- **Every fact checked** against kubernetes.io, CNCF announcements and project documentation, September 2026.
- **Every scenario is original.** Nothing here is a reproduced question bank.
- **One running example:** Quayside, a ferry-booking company, from its first container to GitOps.

> REMEMBER
>
> Where sources disagree or cannot be confirmed, the course says so rather than guessing.

Meet Quayside: the running example

PART OF THE SYSTEM	RUNS AS	EXPLAINED IN
Web front end	Deployment and Service	Modules 7 and 14
Booking API	Deployment, with an autoscaler	Modules 7 and 27
Payment worker	Deployment reading a queue	Module 8
Ticket validator	A tiny distroless image	Module 2
Bookings database	StatefulSet with its own volumes	Modules 8 and 20
Log agent and nightly export	DaemonSet and CronJob	Module 8

REMEMBER

By module 24, every part is deployed from Git. You will know why each one is the kind of object it is.

How to read the slides

- **The top-left label** shows the domain, so you always know which part of the exam you are in.
- **'On the exam'** boxes hold the fact most likely to be tested.
- **'The tiebreaker'** boxes give the one fact that separates two look-alike options.
- **'Currency check'** slides mark something that changed recently.
- **'In five lines'** closes every teaching module: rewatch those for fast revision.

> REMEMBER
>
> If you only have ten minutes, the five-line summaries and tiebreakers are the highest-value revision.

Using the worked scenarios

- **Pause and commit.** Choose your answer before the walkthrough. Watching without answering teaches almost nothing.
- **Read every explanation,** including why each wrong option fails.
- **Right answer, wrong reason, is a miss.** Count it as one.
- **After a miss, ask:** did I not know it, or did I misread the question?

> REMEMBER
>
> Knowledge errors need a rewatch. Reading errors need slower reading. They have different fixes.

Using the practice exams

- **Four papers of twenty,** weighted exactly like the real exam across all eighty questions.
- **Take practice exam 1 only after the teaching modules.** Earlier, it measures nothing.
- **Score by domain,** not just in total. The end of each paper shows how.
- **Leave days between papers,** and aim for a steady 85% before you book.

> REMEMBER
>
> Taking all four papers in one sitting wastes them. Each one is a measurement; space them out.

The study route

01

Watch in order

Modules 1 to 31. Later modules build on earlier ones.

02

Exam 1

Score it by domain.

03

Fix the weakest

Rewatch only that domain's scenarios.

04

Exams 2 to 4

Spaced days apart; repeat the fix each time.

05

Night before

Modules 29 and 30: what changed, and the confusion pairs.

REMEMBER

Revising what you already know feels productive, because the scores stay high. It moves nothing.

The course map

PART	MODULES	SCENARIOS OR QUESTIONS	RUNTIME
Domain 1: Kubernetes Fundamentals	1 to 12	56 scenarios	2h 57m
Domain 2: Container Orchestration	13 to 21	44 scenarios	2h 05m
Domain 3: Application Delivery	22 to 25	28 scenarios	1h 03m
Domain 4: Cloud Native Architecture	26 to 28	16 scenarios	0h 47m
Exam skills	29 to 31	16 checks	0h 34m
Practice exams	32 to 35	80 questions	1h 04m

REMEMBER

8 hours 33 minutes after this introduction. 160 worked scenarios, plus 80 practice questions.

Module 1 starts with the thing everything else rests on: **what a container actually is.**